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**KOPIEREGKLARING-DEKBLAD VIR KOPIEË GEMAAK DEUR
DIE NOORDWES-UNIVERSITEIT (NWU)**

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Chapter 1: Worldviews: dealing with conflict through dialogue

“Debate can be unpleasant at times, but at least it presupposes that there are truths worth defending, ideas worth fighting for. In our postmodernist age, however, your truths are yours, my truths are mine, and none are significant enough to get passionate about. And if there is no truth, then we cannot persuade one another by rational arguments. All that’s left is sheer power-which opens door to a new form of fascism.”

(Colson, 2004:24)

Introduction

Have you ever been in a debate with a person in which you disagreed so much you left the conversation annoyed? Most probably! The fact of the matter is one's life consists of different ideas and opinions which shape our understanding of the world and our understanding of our everyday life. These ideas and opinions are constantly in conflict with each other.

Any form of education is a formation of ideas and opinions. We can compare the university to a gym. Except that instead of training your muscles, at the university, you train your brain. At the university your brain is trained and stretched. This exercise and stretching of your brain is done through new ideas and opinions. Some of these ideas and opinions conflict with each other.

An important question is: In what way can you get the most out of the “University gym”? In what way can you get the most out of the training you receive at the university? Most people get very tired when they exercise in the gym. Similarly, you should get very tired in exercising your brain at university.

In Colson's quote above, he speaks of people who no longer value the exchange of ideas or opinions. These people feel there are no ideas and opinions worth being passionate about. Just think how pointless your studies would be if the lecturers are no longer passionate about the ideas and opinions they convey to you? This is like going to the gym while you are very sick. You do not have the energy to do any exercises and if you walk away you feel worse.

We hope this will not be your experience of university. It is therefore important to understand how to develop different ideas and opinions, how to compare them with each other and how to critically distinguish between good ideas and harmful ideas. In achieving this, it is important to learn how to think critically. One of the main functions of the university is stimulating critical

thought. At university one learns how to think critically, but even more so, how to offer solutions to big problems.

Glanzer *et al* (2017: 143) explains that contemporary education is characterised by critical thinking. According to him, students are proficient at showing why things do not make sense. The problem, however, is that students do not have the ability to make sense of the books they read and the world in which they live.

“The critical thinking, they acquire, especially in postmodern forms, becomes like a sledgehammer used to destroy rather than a bag of tools that help one create.”

(Glanzer et al. 2017:143)

Critical thinking should therefore not be confused with a "sledgehammer" which is only used to smash ideas. No, critical thinking should be a toolbox for you to use to find solutions to the problem you are facing. Use your studies at university to build a useful toolbox which helps you create, rather than destroy.

What is a worldview?

What we think determines the way we act. How we think determines what we do and how we live. For this reason, it is important to know what someone or a group of people think; it enables us to better understand their actions. We can also turn it around and say if you look at someone's behaviour, for example, at the person's clothing, use of language or the way they structure their life, you can start to develop an idea of the way they think. Worldviews also influence the way we think about curriculum. This will become clear as you work through this book.

Who do you think has the greatest influence on the way you think and why?

The German philosopher Immanuel Kant first used the word *weltanschauung* (worldview) to explain that one looks at the world in a subjective way from one's own life (Naugle, 2002: 58). A person's worldview is also sometimes referred to as a person's philosophy, idea or opinion. According to Sire (2004a: 15), a worldview is a set of presuppositions which each person has to determine his understanding of the world. Sire (2004b: 17-20) further develops his idea of a worldview by referring to a worldview as a set of answers to the following six questions:

1. What is real?
2. What is a human being?

3. What happens to a person when he/she dies?
4. Why is it possible to know something?
5. How do we know what is right and wrong?
6. What is the meaning of human history?

Nash (1992: 26-30) tries to identify the aspects of a worldview with the aim of gaining a better understanding of a worldview. According to Nash, a worldview consists of the nature of God, reality, knowledge, morality and man. Walsh and Middleton (1984: 171) organise their framework for a worldview around the following four questions:

1. Who am I?
2. Where am I?
3. What is wrong with the world?
4. What is the solution?

Van der Walt (2000: 51) explains a person's worldview as something which forms the bridge between what a person believes and the way in which a person lives. In simple terms, in examining a person's worldview, we look at whether what the person believes corresponds to what he/she is doing. From this point of view, Van der Walt defines a worldview as:

"An integrated, interpretive, normative-belief perspective on the reality to which human activities give direction and meaning, which in turn spell out man's calling in the world."

To put it briefly, a worldview is a network of beliefs which determine how we understand and experience reality. Other synonyms include ideas, framework, life perspective, faith, vision, life conviction, life view, life philosophy, philosophy, value system, principled framework, ideology and so forth.

Everyone has a worldview

The authors of this book also have a worldview. This means they have ideas and thoughts about how the world works and their ideas and thoughts influence the way they compile the material for the students to learn. Being aware of worldviews is a powerful tool in learning new information. It helps you to realise that behind the information you are reading, there is a person with a particular worldview who wants to communicate certain ideas and in doing so, tries to persuade you of their point of view.

The fact that they have ideas and want to convince you of them is not necessarily wrong. All

people attempt to do this; it's part of life. However, the problem arises when people are not honest about what they are actually teaching. This is where knowledge about worldviews is very useful. It helps you to distinguish clearly between a person's convincing rhetoric and what the person's real beliefs are.

We must remember that most people do not know they have a worldview, yet everyone has one. We can say that everyone wears glasses with which they look at the world, yet they do not always know they are wearing glasses. These glasses for example, make everything they look at seem red, and everything they describe, they describe in red terms. Being unconscious of their worldview means, for example, that they cannot understand why all people do not see the world as they see it. Maybe the person next to them describes the world in green terms, because their lenses are green. Becoming aware of different worldviews helps you realise that there are different ways of looking at the world. Furthermore, it helps you to stand in the shoes of another person and see the world from their point of view.

What is your worldview?

If all people have a worldview, then it means you have one too. But what is your worldview? The link below is a handy test which categorises people into four main worldviews, namely:

1. Traditional worldview
2. Postmodern worldview
3. Modern worldview
4. Integrative worldview

When we talk about main categories of worldviews, it is intended to simplify things. Categorisation is part of our daily life and it helps us to make sense of life. When categorising worldviews, we must be careful not to put people into boxes by characterising them as a particular person with a particular worldview. Putting people into a box and claiming this is how this person thinks, is dangerous. When we look at ourselves, we realise that the way we viewed the world when we were children and the way we view the world now, is different. One's worldview develops and changes as one grows in knowledge and experience.

According to De Witt (2019) it helps to reflect on your and others' worldview because it:

- Increases your self-awareness
- Improves your communication skills

- Helps you to be more creative in using multiple perspectives
- Helps you to be critical about modern trends in society, politics and economics

Which worldview resonate best with you? Take the following personal worldview test at the below link and answer the questions that follow:

<https://annickdewitt.com/intro-worldviewtest/>

Questions

1.3.1 According to the worldview test of De Witt, which worldview resonates best with you?

1.3.2 Read the description of the worldview which resonates best with you. Do you agree that the worldview suits you best? Give reasons for your answer:

1.3.3 List some of the good values of the worldview which resonate best with you?

1.3.4 What type of room for growth is there within the worldview with which you resonate best?

What does a worldview consist of?

Some children like to take their toys apart to see what parts the toy consists of. I remember as a little boy I really enjoyed taking my cars apart, to see what components the car all consisted of. By doing this I came to a better understanding of the car. I developed an understanding of how the different parts of the car fit together. My understanding of how the car works and what the cars consist of broadened.

Similarly, scientists take a phenomenon, open it, take it apart, and see what components it consists of. This same exercise, or scientific experiment, can be done with a worldview. You can take it apart and see what components it consists of. Doing so broadens one's understanding of what a worldview is. This section examines the components of a worldview to better understanding it.

Components of a worldview

Van der Walt (2000: 59) provided a list of the six important components which make up a worldview, namely:

1. **God or Purpose:** Every human being serves a God or a Supreme purpose.
2. **Norms:** Every human being obeys the will of his god/God as it appears in different laws or regulations.

3. **Nature:** Every human being deals with nature as he believes his God/god desires of him/her.
4. **Man:** Every human being becomes more and more like the god/God he/she serves.
5. **Community:** Men and women, together with other people of the same conviction, create a human society.
6. **Time and history:** In this society a certain idea of time and history are developed.

Examples of different worldviews in their components

The following table is an example of two major and relevant worldviews in South Africa. The components are only briefly discussed to serve as an example of what comprises a worldview and to show the way worldviews differ:

Component	African philosophy	Western philosophy
God or Purpose	A creator, god, who is at a distance (deistic).	Their god is secular, materialistic, capitalist.
Norms	Group determines the norms.	The individual determines what is right and wrong.
Nature	Man is part of nature therefore nature should be respected.	Man is separated from nature and nature is to be exploit for prosperity.
Human	The individual aspect of man is subordinated to the group.	Man is determined by individualism and materialism.
Community	Equality in the community comes first, and the group has the highest interest.	The individual's freedom and rights come first, and the community is at the service of the individual.
Time and history	You need to share your time with the group.	Time is used for the individual's advantage; time is money and can be bought.

Questions

Answer each of the following questions to develop a deeper understanding of your worldview:

1. **God or Purpose:** Do you have a God you serve and what would you say is the highest purpose in your life?
2. **Norms:** In what way do you determine if an action is right or wrong?
3. **Nature:** In what way do you look at nature? Is it something that needs to be taken care of or do you think one should exploit it and use the resources which nature offers?
4. **Man:** How do you think man came into being and do you think there is a difference between man and animal? Explain your answer?
5. **Community:** In what way do you think one should be involved in their community? And what do you consider your closest community?
6. **Time and history:** How do you look at time, do you plan your time in the finest detail, or do you prefer a *liaises-faire* approach to time?

Main types of worldviews

There are different ways to categorise worldviews. As mentioned, categories help one to explain some concepts more easily. But placing a person or group within one worldview, and then claiming that all people in that group think the same about all components of a worldview, is not possible. Categories of worldviews enable us to identify mainstream ideas, which in turn helps us to compare them with each other. In this way one can better conceptualise how a particular worldview approaches problems and what solutions to the problem may be.

What follows is a discussion of different categories of worldviews. This distinction is discussed in terms of various researchers' classifications. Each researcher had a different goal in mind and emphasises different components of worldviews.

Worldview categorisation: De Witt

You have already come to know De Witt's categorisation in the Worldview test. This categorisation is especially useful because it contains only four worldviews, which makes it concise. The method that De Witt used to do the categorisation is an epistemological categorisation which categorises worldviews according to the way they view knowledge and how people view their source of authority of knowledge. There are four divisions, namely:

1. Traditional worldview

Read more about this worldview at the following link:

<https://annickdewitt.com/your-worldview-traditional/>

2. Postmodern worldview

Read more about this worldview at the following link:

<https://annickdewitt.com/your-worldview-modern/>

3. Modern worldview

Read more about this worldview at the following link:

<https://annickdewitt.com/your-worldview-postmodern/>

4. Integrative worldview

Read more about this worldview at the following link:

<https://annickdewitt.com/your-worldview-integrative/>

Worldview categorisation: McFarland

A popular way of comparing worldviews is to consider their view of God. In this comparison there are difficult concepts that one must first master. Go to the following link and formulate a short description of each of the following concepts:

<https://visualunit.files.wordpress.com/2011/10/worldview-summary-diagrams-final.jpg>

1. Atheism
2. Pantheism
3. Panentheism
4. Deism
5. Polytheism
6. Monotheism

McFarland's (2007) classification is based on the view of God. In *Summit's Worldview Chart*:

Understanding key players in the battle of ideas, he discusses the following six worldviews, namely:

1. Christianity
2. Islam
3. Secularism
4. Marxism
5. New Age (Spirituality)
6. Postmodernism

<https://www.summit.org/resources/worldview-chart/>

Next, McFarland compares eight worldviews according to their view of God/god:

1. Atheism
2. Pantheism
3. Panentheism
4. Deism
5. Limited Deity
6. Polytheism
7. Monotheism
8. Biblical Christianity

<http://vananne.com/culttoasters/Worldview%20Comparison.PDF>

Questions

Understanding yourself and knowing your worldview is a key component in developing your own ideas. Knowing what your worldview is makes it easier for you to start making comparisons between your worldview and other types of worldviews. Complete the worldview test at the following link:

<https://northernbeachesanglicans.org.au/wp-content/uploads/2016/08/August-16-WorldView.JPG.jpg>

After taking the test, answer the questions that follow:

1. In which block did you end up?
2. Read up on the block where you ended up and give a brief description of your worldview?
3. Did you find the test meaningful and what did you learn about yourself?

Worldviews in a crisis

In the previous sections you developed a good idea of what your worldview is. The following sections guide you how to bring your worldview into dialogue with other worldviews, how to compare different types of worldviews and suggests how to resolve differences that lead to conflict.

Watch the following video and answer the question that follows:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VXnSE0uvwzM&t=6s>

The two characters meet, hang out and then at a meal something happens which makes them realize they have big differences. What happened and why? Highlight some aspects of why they differ?

Crises within a worldview

Have you ever heard the expression, "My world has fallen apart!" It is when something big has happened in a person's life that makes them feel like nothing in their life makes sense anymore. This event could be the death of a loved one, a divorce, an illness, an injury and so forth. A worldview is easily thrown into crisis and it can cause great personal challenges, but also affect large communities or countries.

Van der Walt (2000: 55) discusses three reasons why a worldview ends up in a crisis:

1. Because it is threatened by another, or a stronger worldview.
2. Because the worldviews no longer match the changing living conditions and the relevance of the worldviews is questioned.
- 3 . Because those who hold the worldview begin to doubt it and are no longer fully committed to it.

There are only two types of reactions possible when a worldview falls into crisis:

1. You maintain your worldview,

2. Or you change your worldview.

Should a person decide to maintain their worldview and not make adjustments, they are only digging deeper and deeper into their worldview. This causes them to close their eyes to the realities with which their worldview clashes. According to Van der Walt (2000: 56) this attitude causes an increase in tension. We can compare it to the tension of the Cold War, when the Soviet Union wanted to tie their worldview behind a wall.

When one's worldview is crumbling, it causes existential anxiety, to the point that people become aggressive about protecting their worldview, which in turn leads to conflict between worldviews.

If a worldview no longer is relevant, the realities of life are so strong that the worldview loses power and no longer convinces anyone; consequently, it comes to an end. Should a person decide, or be forced by the realities to change their worldview, Van der Walt (2000: 56) says the following steps follow:

1. The worldview refocuses on the environment to make sense of it again.
2. The old worldview is revised.
3. A new worldview that better interprets circumstances is adopted.

Identifying the problem

Worldviews have come into conflict with each other regularly throughout the centuries. This is the underlying reason for all conflict. People who have the same way of doing things get along well. However, people who look at the world in different ways, do things differently and easily come into conflict with each other. There are significant conflicting worldviews and when they clash, this causes a lot of tension, which sometimes culminates in war. Studying the great conflicts in the world offers one a deeper perspective on why people think and act in a certain way.

An event in the world's recent history that rekindled the awareness of conflicting worldviews, was the attacks in America on 11 September 2001. The effects of the attacks are still visible today because they sparked a war which in turn sparked numerous new revolutions and terrorist's groups. View the video at the following link for more information on the history surrounding the events of 11 September 2001:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nlsnnhn3VWE>

Part of understanding worldviews is to identify the core of a problem which arises around the clash of worldviews. Identifying the core of a problem is an important skill. Many debates are stuck in "side-line" remarks and thoughts that miss the core of the matter. Understanding worldviews helps you focus on the core of an issue. View the following video at the link and write down two important things to identify a problem:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D3oSg3xk73Y>

Getting to the heart of a problem is not easy. This is the starting point in the art of problem-solving. View the following link to learn more about how problems are identified and structured:

<https://www.skillsyouneed.com/ips/problem-solving2.html>

Questions

1. What do you think are the conflicting worldviews that led to the war in the Middle East?
2. Choose one of the worldview components as discussed in 2.1 and compare the two conflicting worldviews in the war of the Middle East.

Are all worldviews equally valid?

“A worldview is a set of presuppositions (assumptions which may be true, partially true, or entirely false) which we hold (consciously or subconsciously, consistently or inconsistently) about the basic makeup of our world.”

Sire (2004b:18)

According to Sire, not all worldviews are equally valid. He says some worldviews are "entirely false". Is this statement too sharp? Is he not judging too harshly?

According to De Witt's classification, postmodernism tends to acknowledge and appreciate numerous perspectives of reality. It argues that people see life and the world very differently, and that all these different perspectives are valuable. A person with a postmodern worldview would not agree with Sire because postmodernism argues that there is no such thing as truth. Truth is considered relative to the person's own choice. From a postmodernist perspective, to say that a person's worldview is "entirely false" is not "right".

Dangerous worldviews

Is it not true that some worldviews have been very dangerous throughout history?

We easily give strong opinions in a convincing way and this is demonstrated in the world of politicians, with the famous saying "I promise you, that I will promise you everything!" The art of listening beyond a person's convincing rhetoric to what the person is actually saying, is important to protect ourselves from false information.

Examples of postmodernist statements are:

"There is no such thing as right or
wrong" "Whatever one believes is right"

"We should not judge, but rather leave people to believe what they want."

These statements sound agreeable, but are they? The postmodern worldview has built into itself a paradox. A paradox is a contradiction; a contradiction is a combination of statements, ideas, or features which are opposed to one another. It is for example a contradiction to teach children smoking is bad while you smoke yourself or calling someone while driving your car and telling them how dangerous it is to drive while taking on the phone.

The paradox build into postmodernism is that it declares all things and thoughts as relative, and thereby declares postmodernism itself as relative. The main function of postmodernism is to question all things, to attack all statements of truth and to declare them invalid. The postmodern worldview therefore causes a boarderlessness, because no boundaries may be drawn within the postmodern worldview. Within the postmodern worldview, therefore, there is no such thing as right or wrong.

The postmodern worldview, which at first glance seems kind-hearted, is in fact very dangerous. The postmodern worldview destroys morality in its proclamation that man must not judge. Morality in the sense of determining right and wrong actions. But if one is not allowed to judge, how do you distinguish between right and wrong. It is only logical that some worldviews are very dangerous, and therefore not valid. If a person believes that it is right to kill people at will, then it is absurd to say: "There is no such thing as right or wrong" . Read the following post:

<https://www.nbcnews.com/news/world/suspect-christchurch-mosque-attack-face-50-murder-charges-police-say-n990801>

The person's actions discussed in the article are wrong and his worldview is very dangerous. We can highlight many worldviews over the centuries and say that these were very dangerous

worldviews. Furthermore, it is not right to adhere to those worldviews. Just think of the Nazis of World War II who killed six million Jews. One key aspect of teaching the Nazi worldview to the German public was through the curriculum in the schools. In this sense curriculums becomes the instrument of teaching a worldview. The battle between worldviews, has an direct influence on the instruments, such as the curriculum, by which the worldviews are communicated.

According to the morality of the postmodern worldview, one cannot say that the actions of the Nazis were wrong. But it is simply logical that a society that upholds this view will degenerate into chaos. People will do as they please and there will be a total decline in morality.

What about tolerance?

The highest value within the postmodern worldview is tolerance. The most important principle of the postmodernist thinker is the proclamation that all thoughts, ideas, views, moral or immoral actions must be tolerated. Carson (2012: 75) says the following about the postmodern concept of tolerance:

“The culture of “tolerance” in which we presently find ourselves is a culture in which people believe nothing, possess no clear concept of right and wrong, and are remarkably indifferent to this precarious state of affairs. As a result of this transmutation., “tolerance” becomes indistinguishable from an intractably intolerant relativism. The challenge facing people of faith is learning how to purify tolerance so that it remains a virtue without succumbing to the centripetal forces of relativism and the spirit of the age.”

In his book *"The Intolerance of Tolerance"*, Carson emphasises an important idea regarding tolerance. According to Carson (2012: 82) tolerance today has become a weapon in the hands of ideologies. In the name of "tolerance" these ideologies prevent other worldviews such as Christianity, Islam, Buddhism, Hinduism and Judaism from practicing their faith. Furthermore, people of these faiths, are described as “narrow minded” and “intolerant”, simply because they take clear positions regarding religion, morality or right and wrong ways of living.

According to Carson (2012: 82), throughout history, it is clear that not all behaviour may be tolerated. Governments must be intolerant of people with worldviews that are harmful to society. For this reason, governments consist of a juridical system, protecting societies from dangerous people who put their dangerous worldviews into practice. However, Carson states in the above quote that we should not get rid of tolerance, but that we should learn how to purify it of the postmodern worldview's relativistic influence. Tolerance between different

worldviews is important for a stable and healthy society. In the next section we examine how to manage conflict between opposing worldviews.

Questions

Visit the following link and answer the questions that

follow: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=19ipEtmet6I>

1. What are the three terms with which the speaker describes Postmodernism?
2. Would you like to be on the plane of a pilot with a postmodern worldview? Motivate your answer?

Worldviews in dialogue

“Reasonable conflict is better than unreasonable conflict. Reasonable people realise and recognise that other people have reasons for their ethical convictions. Such a person should nevertheless realise that, in the interest of peace, s/he should at least try to understand the ethical convictions of the other person, as well as the other person’s reasons for embracing those convictions.”

(Diedericks, 2016:86)

Worldview comes into conflict because people and communities look at things in different ways. Conflict, however, is inevitable. The big question is how should the conflict be handled? There are several ways in which one can react when there are clashes between opposing worldviews:

1. **Dialogue:** This approach is ultimately the best. It is the active decision of both conflicting parties to enter dialogue with each other about their differences.
2. **Takeover:** You may decide to give up your worldview, and rather fall into the stronger, more dominant worldview. You, as it were, leave your worldview and adopt the stronger worldview for the sake of peace.
3. **War:** You can “declare” war against any person or group that differs from you and tries to oppress your worldview. Within major conflicting worldviews in the world, this conflict culminates in wars.
4. **Avoidance:** You can try to close your eyes to conflict. To avoid conflict, you rather walk away and thereby try to avoid the situation.
5. **Flight:** You may decide to flee the conflict instead and relocate. In world history, this has been associated with communities that have fled by immigrating to other countries.

The French Huguenots who came to South Africa in the Sixteenth century are a good example of this.

Bear in mind that, although dialogue is the best way of dealing with conflict, it has been proven throughout history that this is not always possible. If one party, such as Germany in World War II, is not prepared to embark on a path of dialogue, then war is inevitable.

Dialogue as part of being human

When we think of dialogue, we usually think of a conversation which takes place between two people. The one person says one thing and then the other person responds. In his book *On Community and Place*, Goosen (2015) discusses a deeper concept than just the superficial dialogue between two people. According to him, dialogue has to do with more than just a conversation between two people: dialogue is part of being human. Man's understanding of himself and the things around him depends on dialogue. Dialogue is much more than just a conversation; it also includes action. Balthasar (2005: 13) describes this idea of dialogue as follows:

“After a mother has smiled at her child for many days and weeks, she finally receives her child’s smile in response. She has awakened love in the heart of her child, and as the child awakens to love, it also awakens to knowledge: the initially empty-sense impressions gather meaningfully around the core of the Thou.”

In the relationship between a baby and his/her mother who, without words, only through eye contact, gives purpose and meaning to each other. The baby who, after a while, looks at the mother and then smiles. How can we describe what is happening in this situation? A dialogue took place, but more than a dialogue consisting of plain words: a drama took place, in which the mother and the baby each played a role. Without one or the other, the drama would not have been possible.

Man's community forms part of a world-drama, with different characters. Within this drama, there are smaller and bigger events. Within this drama, our lives play out. This drama has love stories, comedy, history and wars. The important thing about this drama is that all the character needs to participate. Every character has to participate to give meaning and purpose to the drama.

A drama has a rationale and makes sense because every character is given the opportunity to fulfil their role. It is in this sense that dialogue should be seen; as a drama in which all the parties must be given the opportunity to play their role. If the characters better understand each

other's roles, the drama forms a clear coordinated whole. If one character dominates the drama, it becomes a monologue and loses its purpose and impact.

The concept of a play is embedded in drama. Characters act and role play. Play is also used as a technique in therapy for children who had traumatic experiences. View the following videos at the links which explain this idea:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DULKnm1SFhE>

And

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SbeS5iezID>

[A](#)

Seeing dialogue as a drama in which you have a part, changes your attitude to how you engage in dialogue with another person. The conflicting worldviews are kept at a distance and are treated as a point of discussion. The tension around the conflict is pushed into the background and the different thoughts are discussed and evaluated. Seeing drama as the 'play of life', which can include any event within everyday life, and allowing each character to participate in the drama, creates an open atmosphere for discussing conflicting worldviews. The voice of all interested parties must therefore be heard, and each character must participate and fulfil their role.

From this concept of dialogue as a drama, and dealing with conflicts between worldviews through dialogue, the following important ideas develop:

- all parties should be given an opportunity to participate in the discussion,
- all the parties' roles should be understood, in order to get a better understanding of their worldviews,
- the core of the drama, issue or problem must be discussed and reflected on,
- the parties participating in the dialogue work towards a solution.

From tolerance to recognition - Searching for solutions

Simply tolerating peoples' or communities' different and conflicting worldviews does not help in the search for solutions to problems. The *Recognition Theory* goes beyond mere tolerance. The *Theory of Recognition* developed by Galeotti (2002: 20) identifies the following principles:

- worldview shifts the recognition of differences from the private to the public,
- worldviews may also receive status in terms of rights,
- tolerance and intolerance towards worldviews require public justification,

- conflict between worldviews will be recognised,
- there is a move from intolerance, to tolerance, to hospitality in the search for solutions between the conflict of worldviews,
- it is acknowledged that there is a truth and that worldviews do not degenerate into relativism,
- worldviews strive to achieve truth in the search for solutions to problems.

The identification of problems also includes the search for solutions to the problems. The following ***Structure in the search for solutions*** is a summary of all the sections discussed in this chapter.

Structure in the search for solutions

Step 1: Read more about the context and background of the problem for which you are trying to find solutions.

E.g. The huge shortage of school buildings and the government's inability to meet the growing need.

Step 2: Identify the core of the problem for which solutions need to be found.

E.g. The department of education receives large sums of funds for the construction of schools, but no schools are built.

Step 3: Identify the underlying worldview component that can be considered as the cause of the problem.

E.g. God, man, community, nature, time and history. (Refer to 2.1)

Step 4: Identify the dominant and opposite worldview associated with the problem and briefly describe each worldview

E.g. Traditional, Postmodern, Modern, Integrative or any others discussed in Section 3.

Step 5: Explain how each worldview identifies the problem

E.g. The Traditional worldview typically views the problem in a way, but the Modern worldview typically views the issue in amanner.

Step 6: Provide a humble idea or answer to the conflict that arises between the two worldviews - with the aim of solving the problem that has been identified. (You can also choose a specific worldview that offers the best solution.)

E.g. My suggestion is that the worldviews in question will examine the underlying points of agreement between them and

Questions

Use the ***Structure in the search for solutions*** and your knowledge of worldviews and write a critical essay in which you discuss the following new development in South African education:

In 2019, Minister of Basic Education Angie Motshekga addressed the 'highly disturbing' issue of teacher absence in South African schools. Absenteeism increased to 10% in April 2019 (Jordaan, 2019).

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